

## SETTLING IN

# First Week After Adoption

A calm first week can help your new companion learn that your home is safe and predictable.

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**Days 1-2: Decompress**

- Keep the environment quiet and allow the pet to explore at their own pace.
- Use the food and routine recommended by the rescue team before making major changes.
- Show the pet where to find water, food, their resting area, and toilet or litter setup.
- Limit visitors and avoid overwhelming introductions.

**Days 3-5: Build a routine**

- Keep meal, walk, play, cleaning, and bedtime routines as consistent as possible.
- Reward calm behaviour and use gentle, positive interactions to build trust.
- Notice what helps the pet relax and what situations make them uncomfortable.
- Continue gradual introductions to rooms, people, and other household pets.

**Days 6-7: Review and adjust**

- Check whether the current feeding, sleep, exercise, and enrichment routine is realistic for your household.
- Write down questions for the rescue team or veterinarian instead of guessing about concerning behaviour or health changes.
- Continue giving the pet time. A week is only the beginning of the adjustment period.

**When you are concerned**

Contact a veterinarian for health or medical concerns. For adoption-specific questions, behaviour history, or transition support, contact the rescue team that placed the animal with you.